



Steering Clear of Toxins During Pregnancy

Practical steps to protect you and your baby from harmful environmental chemical exposures

•  WHY THIS MATTERS

Toxic chemicals are found in air, water, food, and everyday products. During pregnancy, certain exposures can interfere with normal fetal development. Known risks include:

 Premature birth

 Low birth weight

 Developmental and cognitive issues in children

 Childhood and adult cancers

Many chemicals are still being studied — when in doubt, choose safer alternatives.

•  SAFER FOOD CHOICES

✓  Heat food in **glass or ceramic** — not plastic (BPA/phthalates leach when heated)

✓  Choose **BPA-free** canned foods

✓  Select **USDA Organic** produce to minimize pesticides

✓  Wash ALL produce thoroughly under running water

✓  Cook more meals at home with fresh, local ingredients

 **Is Fish Safe?**

Fish is nutritious — but choose low-mercury options. **Avoid:** bigeye tuna, king mackerel, shark, swordfish. **Safe choices:** salmon, tilapia, sardines, shrimp, catfish (2–3 servings/week).

•  HOME & KITCHEN SAFETY

 **Cookware**

Avoid PTFE/Teflon nonstick pans — use ceramic, stainless steel, or cast iron instead

 **Cleaning Products**

Use nontoxic or homemade cleaners (vinegar + baking soda). Avoid chlorine bleach sprays and ammonia products in enclosed spaces

 **Lead Paint**

In older homes (<1978), avoid home renovations — lead dust exposure is dangerous. Use wet cleaning methods to reduce spread

 **Dry Cleaning**

Avoid dry-cleaned clothes when possible — PERC solvent is a known toxin

•  BEAUTY, AIR & WORK SAFETY

 **Personal Care Products**

✓ Avoid: **phthalates, parabens, oxybenzone, triclosan**

✓ Choose "**fragrance-free**" products

✓ Use **EWG's Skin Deep® database** to check product safety (ewg.org/skindeep)

 **Air Quality & Heat**

✓ Stay indoors on high-pollution or extreme heat days

✓  Avoid ALL secondhand smoke (tobacco and vaping)

 **Workplace Concerns**

✓ High-risk jobs: farming 🚜, factories 🏭, healthcare ⚕️

✓ Talk to your ob-gyn and employer about safe conditions

✓ Employers must provide safe environments during pregnancy

✓  Wash hands frequently throughout the day



You Don't Need to Be Perfect — Just Aware

It's impossible to avoid all chemicals — and that's okay. The goal is to make **reasonable, informed choices** to reduce your overall exposure. Small changes add up. Always consult with our office about specific concerns at your home or workplace. We're here to help you navigate a safe, healthy pregnancy. ❤️ — (281) 557-0300

Women's Specialists of Clear Lake · Geoffrey H. Klein, MD · FACOG · DABOM

 400 W Medical Center Blvd, Suite 300, Webster, TX 77598 ·  (281) 557-0300